Intrusion Report II

CDC Team 9: Team 5

Table of Contents

Table of Contents 2

Introduction 3

Access Attempts 3

Administrator Logins from LP to AD 3

Successful SSH Logins 3

Observations 4

Suspicious Activity 4

Administrator Activity on AD 4

Intrusion Report II

CDC Team 9: Team 5

Table of Contents

Table of Contents 2

Introduction 3

Access Attempts 3

Administrator Logins from LP to AD 3

Successful SSH Logins 3

Observations 4

Suspicious Activity 4

Administrator Activity on AD 4

External SSH Access on DB and WMS 4

Explicit Credential Use on AD 4

Root / Sudo Activity 4

Assessment of Impact 5

Confirmed Activity 5

Not Shown in Current Results 5

Note on validation 6

Introduction

Timeframe: This comes from the current flag-loss window. (2026-04-25 12:31 thru 16:45 UTC)

This report analyzes logs from Team 9's environment after iScore showed 7 out of 13 flags lost, focusing on the following.

- Authentication events involving Windows Event IDs 4624, 4634, 4648, and 4672.
- Administrator activity between LP and AD.
- Successful SSH logins to DB and WMS.
- Root / sudo activity on Linux systems.
- Explicit credential use on AD.
- Possible lateral movement and credential compromise.

Unlike Intrusion Report I, this report does show evidence of compromise. The logs show successful privileged logins, successful SSH access from external IPs, and root/sudo activity during the flag-loss window.

Access Attempts

Administrator Logins from LP to AD

Server	**Host**	**IP**	**User**	**Logon Type / Event**	**Notes**

AD	ad.team9.isucdc.com	33.96.50.30	Administrator	3 (Network) / 4624	Administrator successfully logged into AD from LP.
AD	ad.team9.isucdc.com	-	Administrator	Event 4672	Special privileges assigned to Administrator.
AD	ad.team9.isucdc.com	-	Administrator	3 (Network) / 4634	Administrator session logged off.

Successful SSH Logins

Server	**Host**	**IP**	**User**	**Event**	**Notes**
DB	db.team9.isucdc.com	12.110.242.159	Administrator	Accepted password	External SSH login to DB.
DB	db.team9.isucdc.com	12.110.242.161	christy.davis	Accepted password	External SSH login to DB.
DB	db.team9.isucdc.com	68.32.254.50	christy.davis	Accepted password	External SSH login to DB.

DB	db.team9.isucdc.com	68.32.254.50	jacqueline.elliott	Accepted password	External SSH login to DB.
WMS	wms.team9.isucdc.com	12.110.242.161	jacqueline.elliott	Accepted password	External SSH login to WMS.
WMS	wms.team9.isucdc.com	68.32.254.50	jacqueline.elliott	Accepted password	External SSH login to WMS.
WMS	wms.team9.isucdc.com	12.110.242.162	Administrator	Session opened	Administrator session on WMS.

Observations

- AD recorded repeated Administrator logins from 33.96.50.30, which is LP. Immediately after, AD recorded special privileges assigned to Administrator (SeDebugPrivilege, SeBackupPrivilege, etc.), suggesting LP was used to access AD with Administrator privileges.
- Multiple external IPs successfully logged into DB and WMS using real accounts (Administrator, christy.davis, and jacqueline.elliott).
- Some successful logins were near authentication failures, then followed by accepted passwords. This suggests credential compromise or password reuse instead of normal activity.

Suspicious Activity

Administrator Activity on AD

- Event: Administrator successfully logged into AD from 33.96.50.30 (Event ID 4624), followed by special privileges assigned (Event ID 4672).
- Affected Host: ad.team9.isucdc.com

- Context: LP appears to have been used to access AD as Administrator.
- Risk: High.

External SSH Access on DB and WMS

- Event: Successful SSH password logins from external IP addresses.
- Affected Hosts: db.team9.isucdc.com and wms.team9.isucdc.com.
- Context: External IPs used valid credentials (Administrator, christy.davis, jacqueline.elliott) to access internal systems.
- Risk: High.

Explicit Credential Use on AD

- Event: A logon was attempted using explicit credentials (Event ID 4648).
- User / IP: darren.williams from 68.32.254.50.
- Context: Explicit credential use from an external IP during the flag-loss window may indicate credential theft or lateral movement.
- Risk: High.

Root / Sudo Activity

- Event: sudo and su sessions opened for root.
- Users / Hosts: administrator and christy.davis on DB and WMS.
- Context: After successful access, root sessions were opened. This could allow reading flags, changing services, or hiding activity.
- Risk: High.

Assessment of Impact

Confirmed Activity

1. Team 9 lost 7 out of 13 flags on iScore.
2. AD recorded Administrator network logons from LP.
3. AD recorded special privileges assigned to Administrator.
4. DB recorded successful SSH login for Administrator from 12.110.242.159.
5. DB recorded successful SSH logins for christy.davis and jacqueline.elliott from external IPs.
6. WMS recorded successful SSH logins for jacqueline.elliott from external IPs.
7. DB and WMS recorded root / sudo session activity.

8. AD recorded explicit credential use from 68.32.254.50 involving darren.williams.

Not Shown in Current Results

No direct logs show the exact flag file being opened, the exact command used to retrieve the flags, or confirmed exfiltration traffic.

No proof of a Golden Ticket attack, DCSync, or an LSASS dump.

The current logs do not fully explain the repeated blank administrator rows on www, db, and wms (possibly incomplete parsing or missing message fields).

Because of this, we are not claiming direct proof of the exact flag-read command. However, the logs do show successful external access, Administrator activity, and root/sudo sessions during the flag-loss window.

Note on validation

Due to time constraints, we were unable to validate every suspicious event. However, we have strong confidence that Team 9 was compromised during this period.

The strongest evidence includes Administrator network logons from LP to AD, special privileges assigned to Administrator on AD, successful SSH logins to DB and WMS from external IPs, root / sudo sessions on DB and WMS, and explicit credential use on AD from an external IP.

Recommended follow-up actions:

- Review DB, WMS, and LP for flag file access.
- Search shell history for cat, grep, find, curl, wget, scp, tar, base64, flag, and cdc.
- Review Windows Event IDs 4624, 4625, 4634, 4648, 4672, 4688, 4768, 4769, and 4776.
- Review Linux auth logs for Accepted password, Failed password, sudo, su, and session opened.
- Check for new users, SSH keys, sudoers changes, cron jobs, and systemd services.
- Rotate passwords for Administrator, christy.davis, jacqueline.elliott, darren.williams, and any other suspicious accounts.

- Block suspicious external IPs at the firewall.

Conclusion: Team 9’s flag losses were most likely caused by compromised credentials and lateral movement across LP, AD, DB, and WMS. The exact flag-read command was not recovered, but the timing and severity of these events make this the most likely cause of the 7 lost flags.

External SSH Access on DB and WMS 4

Explicit Credential Use on AD 4

Root / Sudo Activity 4

Assessment of Impact 5

Confirmed Activity 5

Not Shown in Current Results 5

Note on validation 6

Introduction

Timeframe: This comes from the current flag-loss window. (2026-04-25 12:31 thru 16:45 UTC)

This report analyzes logs from Team 9's environment after iScore showed 7 out of 13 flags lost, focusing on the following.

- Authentication events involving Windows Event IDs 4624, 4634, 4648, and 4672.
- Administrator activity between LP and AD.
- Successful SSH logins to DB and WMS.
- Root / sudo activity on Linux systems.
- Explicit credential use on AD.
- Possible lateral movement and credential compromise.

Unlike Intrusion Report I, this report does show evidence of compromise. The logs show successful privileged logins, successful SSH access from external IPs, and root/sudo activity during the flag-loss window.

Access Attempts

Administrator Logins from LP to AD

Server	Host	IP	User	Logon Type / Event	Notes
AD	ad.team9.isucdc.com	33.96.50.30	Administrator	3 (Network) / 4624	Administrator successfully logged into AD from LP.
AD	ad.team9.isucdc.com	-	Administrator	Event 4672	Special privileges assigned to Administrator.

AD	ad.team9.isucdc.com	-	Administrator	3 (Network) / 4634	Administrator session logged off.

Successful SSH Logins

Server	**Host**	**IP**	**User**	**Event**	**Notes**
DB	db.team9.isucdc.com	12.110.242.159	Administrator	Accepted password	External SSH login to DB.
DB	db.team9.isucdc.com	12.110.242.161	christy.davis	Accepted password	External SSH login to DB.

DB	db.team9.isucdc.com	68.32.254.50	christy.davis	Accepted password	External SSH login to DB.
DB	db.team9.isucdc.com	68.32.254.50	jacqueline.elliott	Accepted password	External SSH login to DB.
WMS	wms.team9.isucdc.com	12.110.242.161	jacqueline.elliott	Accepted password	External SSH login to WMS.
WMS	wms.team9.isucdc.com	68.32.254.50	jacqueline.elliott	Accepted password	External SSH login to WMS.

WMS	wms.team9.isucdc.com	12.110.242.162	Administrator	Session opened	Administrator session on WMS.

Observations

- AD recorded repeated Administrator logins from 33.96.50.30, which is LP. Immediately after, AD recorded special privileges assigned to Administrator (SeDebugPrivilege, SeBackupPrivilege, etc.), suggesting LP was used to access AD with Administrator privileges.
- Multiple external IPs successfully logged into DB and WMS using real accounts (Administrator, christy.davis, and jacqueline.elliott).
- Some successful logins were near authentication failures, then followed by accepted passwords. This suggests credential compromise or password reuse instead of normal activity.

Suspicious Activity

Administrator Activity on AD

- Event: Administrator successfully logged into AD from 33.96.50.30 (Event ID 4624), followed by special privileges assigned (Event ID 4672).
- Affected Host: ad.team9.isucdc.com

- Context: LP appears to have been used to access AD as Administrator.
- Risk: High.

External SSH Access on DB and WMS

- Event: Successful SSH password logins from external IP addresses.
- Affected Hosts: db.team9.isucdc.com and wms.team9.isucdc.com.
- Context: External IPs used valid credentials (Administrator, christy.davis, jacqueline.elliott) to access internal systems.
- Risk: High.

Explicit Credential Use on AD

- Event: A logon was attempted using explicit credentials (Event ID 4648).
- User / IP: darren.williams from 68.32.254.50.
- Context: Explicit credential use from an external IP during the flag-loss window may indicate credential theft or lateral movement.
- Risk: High.

Root / Sudo Activity

- Event: sudo and su sessions opened for root.
- Users / Hosts: administrator and christy.davis on DB and WMS.
- Context: After successful access, root sessions were opened. This could allow reading flags, changing services, or hiding activity.
- Risk: High.

Assessment of Impact

Confirmed Activity

1. Team 9 lost 7 out of 13 flags on iScore.
2. AD recorded Administrator network logons from LP.
3. AD recorded special privileges assigned to Administrator.
4. DB recorded successful SSH login for Administrator from 12.110.242.159.
5. DB recorded successful SSH logins for christy.davis and jacqueline.elliott from external IPs.
6. WMS recorded successful SSH logins for jacqueline.elliott from external IPs.
7. DB and WMS recorded root / sudo session activity.

8. AD recorded explicit credential use from 68.32.254.50 involving darren.williams.

Not Shown in Current Results

No direct logs show the exact flag file being opened, the exact command used to retrieve the flags, or confirmed exfiltration traffic.

No proof of a Golden Ticket attack, DCSync, or an LSASS dump.

The current logs do not fully explain the repeated blank administrator rows on www, db, and wms (possibly incomplete parsing or missing message fields).

Because of this, we are not claiming direct proof of the exact flag-read command. However, the logs do show successful external access, Administrator activity, and root/sudo sessions during the flag-loss window.

Note on validation

Due to time constraints, we were unable to validate every suspicious event. However, we have strong confidence that Team 9 was compromised during this period.

The strongest evidence includes Administrator network logons from LP to AD, special privileges assigned to Administrator on AD, successful SSH logins to DB and WMS from external IPs, root / sudo sessions on DB and WMS, and explicit credential use on AD from an external IP.

Recommended follow-up actions:

- Review DB, WMS, and LP for flag file access.
- Search shell history for cat, grep, find, curl, wget, scp, tar, base64, flag, and cdc.
- Review Windows Event IDs 4624, 4625, 4634, 4648, 4672, 4688, 4768, 4769, and 4776.
- Review Linux auth logs for Accepted password, Failed password, sudo, su, and session opened.
- Check for new users, SSH keys, sudoers changes, cron jobs, and systemd services.
- Rotate passwords for Administrator, christy.davis, jacqueline.elliott, darren.williams, and any other suspicious accounts.

- Block suspicious external IPs at the firewall.

Conclusion: Team 9’s flag losses were most likely caused by compromised credentials and lateral movement across LP, AD, DB, and WMS. The exact flag-read command was not recovered, but the timing and severity of these events make this the most likely cause of the 7 lost flags.